

one of Netscape's better features, this is how you can enable it in case it hasn't been enabled. Click on **Edit > Preferences** to access the Preferences window. Expand the Navigator tree and select Tabbed Browsing. Select the options you want. You can open a new tab by pressing [Ctrl] + [T] and cycle through all the opened tabs by pressing [Ctrl] + [PgUp] or [Ctrl] + [PgDn].

Searching from Netscape
The default search engine for searching from within Netscape is Google, but you can set another search engine. Go to **Edit > Preferences** and select Internet Search. You can specify the search engine that you want to work with from within the drop down list. Finally, click on OK to set the preference. If you enter a term on the Address bar that cannot be resolved into a Web page, Netscape will now automati-



Set in the search preferences

cally search for it in the default search engine.

Enabling Quick Launch
If you have not configured Netscape to load at startup, then enabling the Quick Launch option will give you fast loading times. To enable Quick Launch, click on **Edit > Preferences** and select Advanced from the list at the left. In the Advanced menu, under 'Enable features that increase performance', select Enable Quick Launch and select OK. After a reboot, you should see Netscape loading faster.

MULTIMEDIA



VirtualDub Compressing Video

If you have large MPEG files and would like to see them converted into smaller sizes, you can choose to re-encode them into the AVI (Audio Video Interleave) format. The best AVI codec is the DivX codec series. However, you would need to have the DivX codec installed in your computer. You can also use the Indeo codecs, which give good results.

Open the file in Virtual-

Dub and go to **Video > Compression**. The options listed will be the ones for which the codecs are present in your machine. Choose the DivX codec, which gives the ideal balance between file size and quality. Click on OK; this brings you back to the main screen. Click on **File > Save as AVI** and save the output file. The conversion then starts and you can monitor the progress of the encoding from the VirtualDub Status indicator.



Encoding with the Indeo codecs

If you are using the Indeo AVI codecs, then in the **Video > Compression** screen, you will need to specify the video compression quality—choosing a value between 80 to 90 per cent should give you good file sizes with little loss in quality. Lower settings will affect the quality, but will give you lower file sizes. You will also need to enter the value for a keyframe interval—this will ensure quick fast-forwards and rewinds within the video file. A lower value here is recommended. Select a value of 85, which will give you good results.

Filters
VirtualDub comes with some very useful filters. You can use these to resize or realign your video files, crop or integrate



Using the filters in VirtualDub

special effects such as motion blur or smoothing into the video files. The filters are accessed from **Video > Filters**. For example, if you would like to have still smaller file sizes, you can resize the video. To resize the video, open the source file. Then click on **Video > Filters** and then click on Add. This will open a list of available filters. Choose 2:1 Reduction (High Quality) and click OK. You can add more filters to the list in the same way. Then choose your compression settings and save as an AVI file. You select the order in which you want the effects applied.

dBpower AMP Music Converter Right-click!

To start using dBpower AMP, all you need is to have the plugins for the format into which you need to encode your audio files. Once you have



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